

Unscrapbooking

A Process to bring light to the darker memories of our lives

Unscrapbooking is a term that popped into my head when I was looking through some photos of the harder parts of my life. Okay,. the hardest parts of my life. I hit life's hashier realities at a young age and with not much help. Looking through childhood photos has been a painful reminder of so many hidden hurts and shame.

And here I am now, a stay at home mom, trying to support others who invite me to scrapbooking parties and workshops to sell the wares of a parent company that provides a bit of income to the salesperson, and some gifts for the hostess. Next up, scrapbooking. Creative Memories. Well, shit.

All these beautifully creative pages with the stories of our lives, memories of that fabulous vacations, spotlighting that achievement. Don't get me wrong, that is so very important. TO really shine a light on the high points when they come. Hold those high points high! Decorate the shit outta that stuff!

But where I am now, it is dark, bleak, and a no-go on the same ol' same ol'. I got some shit to heal. Some real gritty shit. And, I'm gonna do with whatever is at arms reach. Which just so happens to be:

12x12 inch scrapbooking paper,
a box of photos,
black paper, any paper
gel pen, any pen
envelopes,
and tape, glue sticks, adhesive dots, anything to make the shit stuff
a scrapbook

I keep all my pages together in one book, the Unscrapbook, that I decorated with duct tape, and used a marker to change the plain, but pretty butterfly on the cover. Make it a little shittier. But with some white for hope. I mean, it's a butterfly after all >< We are transforming this shit, right. Healing it. Anything beautiful that comes from shit, mud, a molecular soup in a cocoon, that is a perfect fit.

Just, by the way, if you choose to share this work of your with anyone. DO NOT share it with some that say the following:

Me: I think I am ready to share this unscrapbook with you
him: Awesome!

Uh, what? Awesome? The shittiest, ugliest, most shameful parts of my life. The thing that I been crying big ass tears over for the past few weeks?

Um. No. This person doesn't get it! MOVE ON! Do not share with someone who cannot hold your truth. That is their limitation, not yours. Find another resource. A paid mental health professional you trust. But no, do not share with anyone smaller than you and your good, hard work. Please. DO yourself this favor.